



Handout 4.11: Client Cards and Needs and Wants List

Print the six cards on card stock, one set per table, and cut. Print the Needs and Wants List (page 2) one per student.



The six client cards

Each card has the six parts of a brief. Who the client is. The room: its measurements, and where the door, window, and closet are. The budget. What the client must have (needs). What the client would like (wants). One rule that cannot be broken. Every number on the card is fixed. Everything else is yours to decide.

Card 1: The Okafor family (Path A, Design Your Own Bedroom for a client)

Picture line: a walker

Who: Grandpa Emeka Okafor, 78, is moving in with his son's family. He uses a walker. He is sharp, likes the news, and keeps his photos close. He gets the spare bedroom.

The room: 11 feet by 12 feet. The door is 3 feet wide, on an 11-foot wall, 1 foot from the corner; it swings into the room. One window, 4 feet wide, is centered on the opposite 11-foot wall. The closet is 2 feet deep by 5 feet wide, on a 12-foot wall, at the corner nearest the window. Ceiling 8 feet.

Must have (needs):

- A bed he can get in and out of with the walker, with one open side facing the path
- A clear path at least 36 inches wide from the door to the bed, and from the bed to the closet
- Nothing on the floor that can catch the walker's feet
- A chair with arms and a firm seat
- A lamp he can turn on from the bed
- A night light on the path

Would like (wants):

- A place for his photos where he can see them from the bed
- A small TV
- His favorite color is blue

Budget: \$400

The rule: no loose rugs. A rug must be flat and taped down, or there is no rug.

Card 2: The Delgado family (Path A)

Picture line: a desk and two beds

Who: Mia Delgado, 13, shares a bedroom with her sister Luz, 8. Mia has homework every night and no quiet place to do it. Luz's toys are everywhere.

The room: 12 feet by 14 feet. The door is 3 feet wide, on a 12-foot wall, at the corner; it swings into the room. One window, 4 feet wide, is centered on a 14-foot wall. The closet is 2 feet deep by 6 feet wide, on the 12-foot wall opposite the door. Ceiling 8 feet.

Must have (needs):

- Two sleeping spots (two twin beds, or a bunk bed)
- A study corner for Mia with a desk, a light, and a shelf, that Luz's toys do not spill into
- Storage for both sisters' clothes
- A place for Luz's toys that is not the floor
- A clear path at least 30 inches wide from the door to each bed and to the closet

Would like (wants):

- A divider or curtain between the two sides
- A spot for Luz to play on the floor
- Mia wants purple; Luz wants yellow

Budget: \$400

The rule: if there is a bunk bed, the older sister takes the top.

Card 3: The Nguyen family (Path A, a mudroom in the front entry)

Picture line: a coat hook and a boot

Who: Two parents, two kids in elementary school, and a dog. Every morning, four people and a dog leave through one small front entry. Every afternoon, everything they carried comes back in and lands on the floor.

The room: the front entry is 6 feet by 9 feet. The front door is 3 feet wide, on a 6-foot wall, and swings into the entry. An open doorway (no door), 3 feet wide, is on the opposite 6-foot wall, leading to the living room. One small window, 2 feet wide, is on a 9-foot wall near the front door. No closet. Ceiling 8 feet.

Must have (needs):

- A place to sit and take shoes off
- Hooks for four coats and four backpacks, at heights the kids can reach
- A bin or cubby for each person's shoes
- A spot for the dog's leash and a towel
- A mat for wet shoes inside the front door
- The front door must open all the way
- A clear path at least 36 inches wide straight through from the front door to the living room doorway

Would like (wants):

- A mirror
- A spot for mail and keys
- A bench with storage inside it

Budget: \$400

The rule: nothing in the swing of the front door.

Card 4: The Ahmed family (Path A)

Picture line: a crib

Who: Sami and Leyla Ahmed live in a one-bedroom apartment. Their first baby is due next month. The baby will sleep in their bedroom for the first year.

The room: 11 feet by 13 feet. The door is 3 feet wide, on an 11-foot wall, at the corner; it swings into the room. One window, 4 feet wide, is centered on a 13-foot wall. The closet is 2 feet deep by 5 feet wide, on the other 13-foot wall, near the door. Ceiling 8 feet.

Must have (needs):

- Their full-size bed stays
- A crib with clear space around it, at least 3 feet from the window and from any cord, heater, or shelf that could fall
- A changing spot with supplies within arm's reach, so no one turns away from the baby
- A chair for night feedings, near the crib
- A clear path at least 30 inches wide from the door to the bed, the crib, and the closet
- Window coverings with no dangling cords

Would like (wants):

- A lamp that can dim
- Soft, calm colors
- A small dresser for baby clothes

Budget: \$400

The rule: nothing goes in the crib but the baby and a fitted sheet (safe sleep, from Lesson 3.17).

Card 5: Jordan and Sam (Path B, Tiny House)

Picture line: a tiny house on a trailer

Who: Jordan and Sam are a couple in their late twenties. They both work from laptops. They want to own a home without a mortgage, so they are building a tiny house on a trailer. The shell is built. The inside is empty.

The home: the inside is 8 feet wide by 24 feet long (192 square feet). The ceiling is 10 feet at the high end. A sleeping loft, 8 feet by 8 feet, sits over one end of the house, with 4 feet of headroom (nobody can stand up there). Under the loft the ceiling is 6 feet. The door is 3 feet wide, on a long wall, 3 feet from the loft end, and swings out. Each long wall has two windows, 3 feet wide each. There is one small window at the far end.

Must have (needs):

- A kitchen with a two-burner cooktop, a sink, a mini fridge, and at least 4 feet of counter
- A bathroom, 3 feet by 5 feet, with a shower and a composting toilet, with a door or a curtain
- A table where two people can work and eat at the same time
- Seating for two
- Storage for clothes and for food
- The loft is the bedroom: a mattress up there and a ladder or stairs to reach it
- A clear path at least 30 inches wide from the door to every zone

Would like (wants):

- A spot for one bike inside
- A window seat
- Plants
- They like white, natural wood, and green

Budget: \$1,500 for the interior (furniture, fixtures, storage, finish; not the building itself)

The rule: every piece has to fit through the 3-foot door or fold.

Card 6: The Rivera family (Path A)

Picture line: a wheelchair

Who: Marco Rivera, 15, uses a manual wheelchair after a car accident last year. He is back at school, plays video games, and is tired of a bedroom he cannot get around in.

The room: 12 feet by 14 feet. The door is on a 12-foot wall, at the corner, and is being widened to 36 inches clear; it swings into the room. One window, 4 feet wide, is centered on a 14-foot wall. The closet is 2 feet deep by 6 feet wide, on the 12-foot wall opposite the door. Ceiling 8 feet.

Must have (needs):

- A turning circle 60 inches (5 feet) across, somewhere in the open floor, and space to turn beside the bed
- A clear path at least 36 inches wide from the door to the bed, the desk, the closet, and the window
- A bed about 20 inches high (the same as his chair seat), with open space on one side for the transfer
- A desk he can roll under: open underneath, 27 to 30 inches high
- A closet rod at 48 inches or lower, and shelves he can reach from the chair
- Light switches and outlets he can reach from the chair
- Nothing on the floor that catches wheels (no thick rugs)

Would like (wants):

- A gaming setup
- A wall for posters
- He likes gray and orange

Budget: \$400

The rule: every path is 36 inches.



Needs and Wants List (one per student)

Name: _____ Date: _____ Client card number and name: _____

Path (circle one): A, Design Your Own Bedroom for a client / B, Tiny House

Working (circle one): alone / with _____

Part 1: The facts from the card

Fact	From the card
The client (who lives with this room)	
The room's measurements	_____ feet by _____ feet
Where the door is, and how wide	
Where the window(s) are	
Where the closet is (or "none")	
The budget	\$_____
The one rule	

Part 2: Sort every line

Copy every “must have” and “would like” line from the card. Some cards have as many as 11 lines. Next to each line, write N or W. N means need: the design fails without it. W means want: nice if the money and space allow. Then add two hidden needs. A hidden need is something the card did not say out loud, but a designer would know this client needs it.

[illegible]

Hidden need 1:	N	
Hidden need 2:	N	

Sentence frame for the “why” column: “__ needs __ because __.”

Part 3: The design problem

Write one sentence. It must name the client, the need, and the limit (the room size or the budget or both).

“_____ needs a room that _____ within _____.”

Part 4: Exit slip (tear off and hand in)

My client is _____. The one thing this room fails without is _____.
The one thing I am not sure how to fit is _____.

Word bank: need (necesidad), want (deseo), client (cliente), budget (presupuesto), rule (regla).